



HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES
COMMONWEALTH OF PENNSYLVANIA
HARRISBURG

July 17, 2013

121 IRVIS OFFICE BUILDING
P.O. BOX 202016
HARRISBURG, PENNSYLVANIA 17120-2016
PHONE: (717) 787-4444
FAX: (717) 780-4772

1240 MERCHANT STREET, 1ST FLOOR
AMBRIDGE, PENNSYLVANIA 15003
PHONE: (724) 266-7774
(412) 565-3569
FAX: (724) 266-7634

WWW.PAHOUSE.NET/MATZIE

The Honorable Ellen Ferretti, Acting Secretary
Department of Conservation and Natural Resources
Commonwealth of Pennsylvania
400 Market St #7
Harrisburg, PA 17120

Dear Acting Secretary Ferretti:

I am writing on behalf of the Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) who in conjunction with the Borough of Coraopolis has submitted an application for funding.

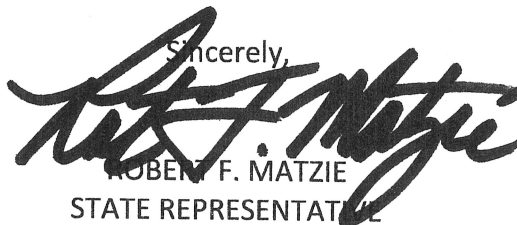
The ORTC was the recipient of the \$200,000 U.S. Department of Transportation Grant for the engineering of the Ohio River South Shore Trail. In order to secure the required matching funds for the federal grant, the ORTC assisted Coraopolis in applying for \$200,000 in Department of Conservation and Natural Resources funding for the Ohio River Trail.

I wholeheartedly support this application which would secure funding to develop a multi-use land trail along the Ohio River and its tributaries. The trail will serve as a key segment in the interconnection of existing land trails in the quad-state area including my legislative district.

I believe the Great Allegheny Passage has demonstrated the benefits for the region of a successful trail as more than \$40 million in direct annual spending and \$7.5 million in payroll is attributed to trail users each year.

Again, I fully support the application and believe it will improve upon the quality of life of our region while also expanding the Commonwealth's tourism economy.

Thank you for your consideration and please do not hesitate to contact me if I can speak further about this application.

Sincerely,

ROBERT F. MATZIE
STATE REPRESENTATIVE

"SERVING ALLEGHENY & BEAVER COUNTIES"